

Daniel Rodriguez

iOS Engineer · Game Developer

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SUMMARY

iOS engineer with 15+ years of experience building award-winning apps and games — from consumer startups to established brands. Deep expertise in Swift and SwiftUI, with a unique background spanning mobile engineering, augmented reality, and game development. Known for delivering full-featured iOS products as a sole engineer and for pioneering AI-assisted development workflows. Annual Global Game Jam participant since 2019. Bilingual (English / Spanish).

EXPERIENCE

Founding iOS Engineer

Adapter Group — New York, NY · December 2024 – March 2026

- Sole engineer on the iOS application — took the product from zero to App Store in under a year, with no other engineers involved.
- Built a real-time AI assistant interface featuring SSE-powered streaming chat, REST API integration, and a fully custom SwiftUI component library.
- Navigated a multi-month Apple App Store review process, resolving policy feedback iteratively to ship successfully.
- Pioneered an AI-native development workflow (Claude Code + Warp.dev), demonstrating that a single engineer could deliver a production-grade consumer app at startup pace.

Personal Projects & R&D — AR, Games & Mobile

Independent — New York, NY · January 2020 – Present

- Dedicated time to hands-on exploration of ARKit, RealityKit, and SparkAR through personal prototyping projects.
- Participated in the Global Game Jam annually, shipping a complete game from scratch each year with small teams using Godot and Unity.

Senior Software Engineer — iOS & AR

Warby Parker — New York, NY · July 2021 – October 2024

- Developed and maintained iOS features for Warby Parker's consumer app — featured by Apple on the App Store.
- Spearheaded development of an internal iPadOS measurements app from scratch using Apple Vision frameworks, deployed across all Warby Parker stores nationwide.
- Led a large-scale AR tech stack migration from SceneKit to RealityKit and built a standalone internal iOS tool to streamline the 3D asset pipeline for AR experiences.
- Architected AR experiences including glasses removal and branded Easter eggs, with collaborations for the Spider-Man 2 (PS5) launch.

Senior Software Engineer — iOS

Zipari — New York, NY · September 2020 – July 2021

- Built and maintained iOS features for a health insurance consumer platform.
- Led efforts to improve the tech stack and introduced new processes for feature development.

Senior Software Engineer — iOS

Paperless Post — New York, NY · July 2015 – June 2020

- Core iOS engineer for 5 years, owning development and maintenance of the consumer app through the full Objective-C to Swift transition.
- Led yearly adoption of new Apple platform features, keeping the app competitive at each iOS launch.
- Mentored a team of 5–10 mobile engineers, guiding best practices and code quality across the platform.

EARLY CAREER

Lead Mobile Game Engineer — HOMER Learning (2014–2015)

Sole mobile engineer (reporting to CTO) on an iPad game teaching children to read. Shipped features on monthly release cycles.

Lead Software Engineer — AnyoneGame / Just Sing It (2013–2014)

Sole engineer for a social karaoke app with 200K+ users. Took two apps from concept to App Store — marking the pivot from game development into iOS engineering.

Technical Lead & Game Programmer — FreshPlanet / Gameloft (2010–2013)

Shipped multiple social and mobile games on Facebook Canvas, iOS, and Android. Built Adobe AIR Native Extensions in Objective-C and Java.

Software Engineer / Assistant Professor — Carnegie Mellon University (2010)

Built a no-code AR exhibit creation tool for museum staff. Co-taught Building Virtual Worlds; advised undergraduate thesis via semester exchange with Universidad de Monterrey.

PROJECTS & COMMUNITY

Global Game Jam — Annual Participant

Worldwide Event · 2019 – Present (unbroken streak)

- Participated every year since 2019, completing a full game from scratch over a 48-hour weekend each time.
- Builds games with small teams of 2–3 using Godot, spanning a wide range of themes and mechanics.
- Reflects an ongoing commitment to game craft, rapid prototyping, and creative collaboration outside of day-to-day work.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

Master of Entertainment Technology · 2008 – 2009

Sketch-It-Up! — Publication: Bulut Karakaya, Camilo Garcia, Daniel Rodriguez, Manoj Nityanandam, Nadia Labeikovsky and Theyab Al-Tamimi. "Sketch-It-Up! Demo", Lecture Notes in Computer Science: Entertainment Computing – ICEC 2009 (2009): 313–14.

Universidad de los Andes — Bogotá, Colombia

B.Sc., Computer and Software Engineering · 2000 – 2006 · Focus: Real-time computer graphics

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Languages: Swift · Objective-C · Python · GDScript

Frameworks: SwiftUI · UIKit · Combine · ARKit · RealityKit · SceneKit · Godot

Tools & Platforms: Xcode · Zed · VSCode · Git · Claude (Anthropic) · Warp.dev · REST APIs · SSE · App Store Connect

Spoken Languages: English (native) · Spanish (native / bilingual)